horses was to be found anywhere. So, they began to leave their horses beyond that camp.

Babur has said, ‘After passing Chūtīālī, my own felt-tent had to be left from want of baggage-beasts.’[*]

In that period, one night it poured very heavily. There was knee-deep water inside his tent. All Babur could do was wait the night out, uncomfortably sitting on a pile of blankets.

Bāqī Chaghānīānī’s Betrayal

They marched further after the rain stopped. Within a few moments, Mīrzā came and said to Babur, ‘have some information that must be delivered privately.’ Accordingly, they both moved to a private space. He said, ‘Bāqī Chaghānīānī came and said to me, “You make the Padishah cross the water of Sindh with seven to ten persons, then make yourself Padishah.”’

Hearing this, Babur said with a smile, ‘What others are heard of as consulting with him?’

Jahāngīr Mīrzā replied, ‘It was but a moment ago Bāqī Beg spoke to me; I know no more.’

Babur said, ‘Find out who the others are; likely enough Sayyid Ḥusain Akbar and Sulṭān ‘Alī the page is in it, as well as Khusrau Shāh’s begs and braves.’[†]

Babur was very pleased with Jahāngīr Mīrzā. He writes praise as below:[‡]

> Here the Mīrzā really behaved very well and like a blood-relation; what he now did was the counterpart of what I had done in Kāhmard, in this same ill-fated mannikin’s other scheme of treachery.

Impressed by his loyalty, Babur made Jahāngīr lead a body of strong men to raid the Afghāns in the neighbourhood.

Since Babur’s men had been leaving horses behind at each camping ground, they only had 300 horses left. The men of the first rank were completely on foot. One such household-brave was Sayyid Maḥmūd Aūghlāqchī. He left his horses behind and began to walk for the rest of the path. In this state, as to horses, we went all the rest of the way to Ghaznī.

By the time they finished four more marches, Jahāngīr Mīrzā had plundered some Afghāns and brought in a few sheep as war booty.